scholar. When Badauni had fallen from Akbar's favour yet again due to a prolonged absence from court a few years previously, Faizi had written an eloquent and sympathetic appeal to the Padshah. 'He is not avaricious,' wrote Faizi about Badauni, 'has a contented mind, is not vacillating, is truthful, straightforward, respectful, unambitious, humble-spirited, meek, moderate in his requests and entirely devoid of the dissimulation so common at court, and entirely faithful and devoted to the Imperial Court.'

About his death, Badauni wrote that Faizi left behind 4,600 'valuable bound books all corrected', that became part of the Padshah's collection. Akbar had them catalogued in three sections— the first section had 'books of verse, medicine, astrology and music, the middle place to works on philosophy, religious mysticism, astronomy and geometry, and the lowest place to commentaries, the traditions, books on theology and all other subjects connected with the sacred law'.

Badauni would not long outlive Faizi. He died the following year, probably in 1596, having completed his memoir in which he wrote of all the bitterness and misery which had stalked his life, and of the Padshah of whom he had had such high hopes and who so disappointed Badauni by not being the great Islamic leader he wanted him to be.

The last year of Badauni's life would no doubt have been made even more miserable by the presence of the third Jesuit mission at Lahore. The Fathers wrote with joy about the sincere affection with which both Akbar and Salim greeted them, embracing the men when they arrived at court. Akbar gave them lodgings in a large house close to the riverbank, under the windows of the palace, and far from the noisy distractions of the town. The night after their arrival, Akbar summoned the Jesuits and showed them the various holy images of Christ and the Virgin Mary which earlier missions had given him. Akbar was holding the paintings, wrote the Jesuits, 'as reverently as though he had been a Christian'. Seeing the holy pictures the Jesuits immediately fell upon their knees following which the little grandson of the king also knelt down and clasped his hands together. This was the young Khusrau, and Akbar was greatly pleased by his behaviour and turned to Salim and said, 'Look at your son.' Salim was extremely cordial with the Jesuits, helping them locate a suitable house within the royal grounds and showing enthusiasm for their religious activities. On a particularly sweltering day in summer, he sent the Jesuits a precious box of snow, as a mark of particular favour.